

Helping horses

Other than traveling by sea, the fastest way to get around Anglo-Saxon England was on horseback. Blacksmiths had an important role to play, making the horseshoes that protect horses' feet and the stirrups that made riding easier.



HORSESHOE

These rivets fixed the shoe to the horse's foot.



STIRRUPS

The rider's foot slots in here, resting on the bar.

Legendary smith

Blacksmiths were highly respected, and were even the heroes of myths and folktales. This casket shows the legend of Wayland (seen on the far left), a blacksmith of great skill who wreaked gory revenge on the king who captured him.



The blacksmith's treasured tools are hanging here for all to see. They will end up in the hands of a Viking.

The roof is made of flammable thatch and the smith must be careful so that no sparks from the furnace set it alight.

The village forge

The blacksmith was an important member of the village community. At his forge he made and repaired metal objects. Many villagers relied on him to maintain the tools they used each day.



Horses are expensive. This one belongs to a local landowner.

The blacksmith's brave assistant is prepared to stand by his master as a Viking races toward him.

The blacksmith spends all day working with heavy metal—he is one of the strongest men in the village. Now he'll use his strength to fight back against the raiders.

This Viking is hunting for swords or anything else that could be used as a weapon.

Everyday items

Iron objects including farming tools, cooking pots, pins, and knives have been discovered at Lindisfarne. Archaeologists have also found weapons such as swords and spearheads.



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